Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative

June 2025

WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY

5th JUNE

Indian handmade gets it right















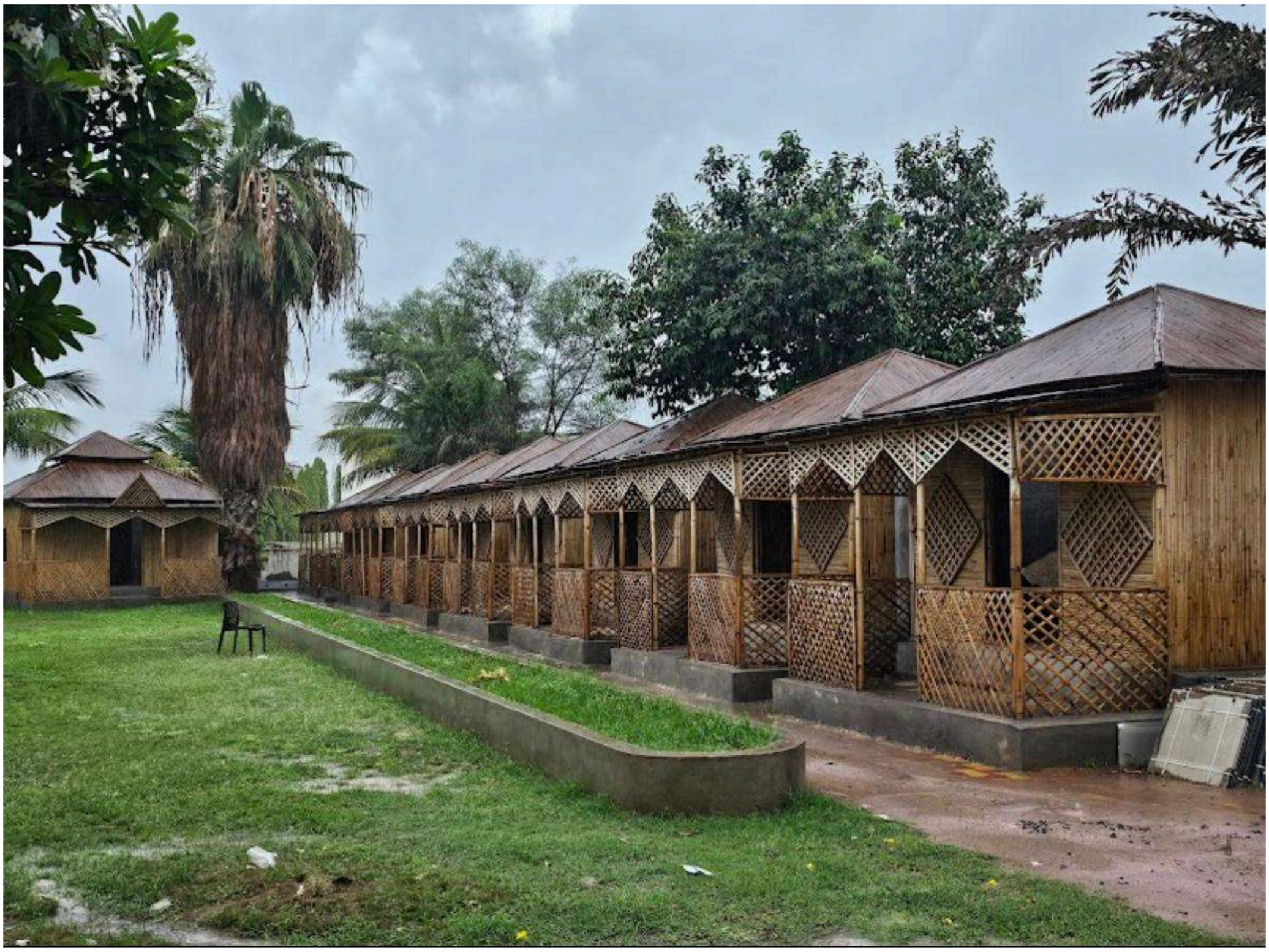


To be an environment conscious consumer is to prioritize informed choices, ethical practices and sustainability. Buyers of Indian handmade products already tick these boxes.

Now the Indian handmade movement is taking this eco-mindfulness further.

Reversing urban migration

Handicraft villages, promoting craft tourism, are cropping up all over the country. Gujarat and Rajasthan lead the drive but search and you will find dozens of craft villages in other states.



This is creating a vibrant rural revival; better exposure and more jobs for artisan communities, a lower cost of living, improved housing, happier families and a richer output.



Anegundi in the Koppal district of Karnataka supports a community of artisans making baskets, mats and bags from water hyacinth and banana fibre. That the craft village is close to Hampi, the UNESCO world heritage site, makes it an added attraction.

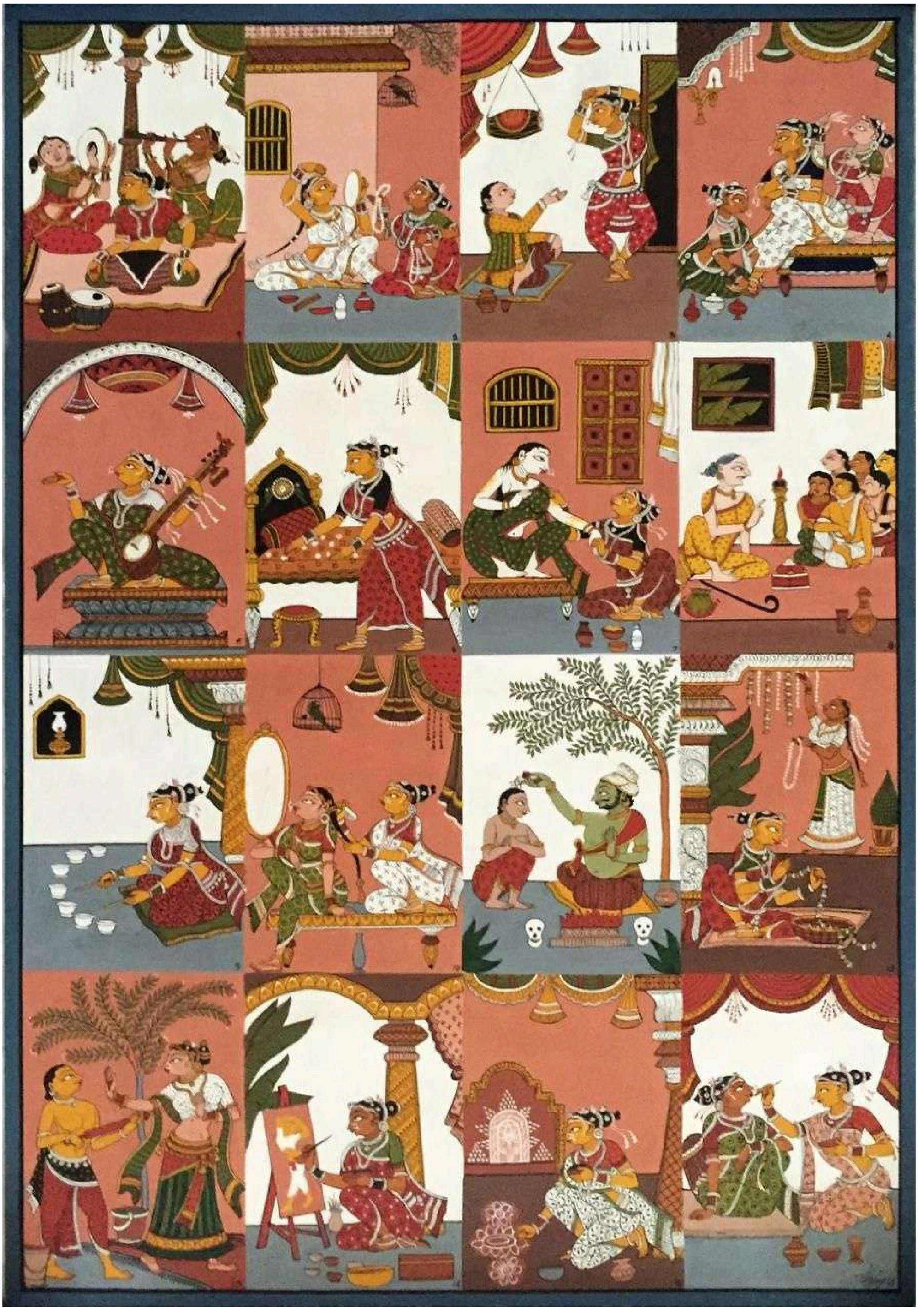






Pranpur in Madhya Pradesh is India's first handloom village. It attracts so many visitors that it is developing homestays to enhance the tourist experience. 450 families are engaged in weaving the gossamer-fine Chanderi silk of the region, using skills handed down from their ancestors for over 700 years.



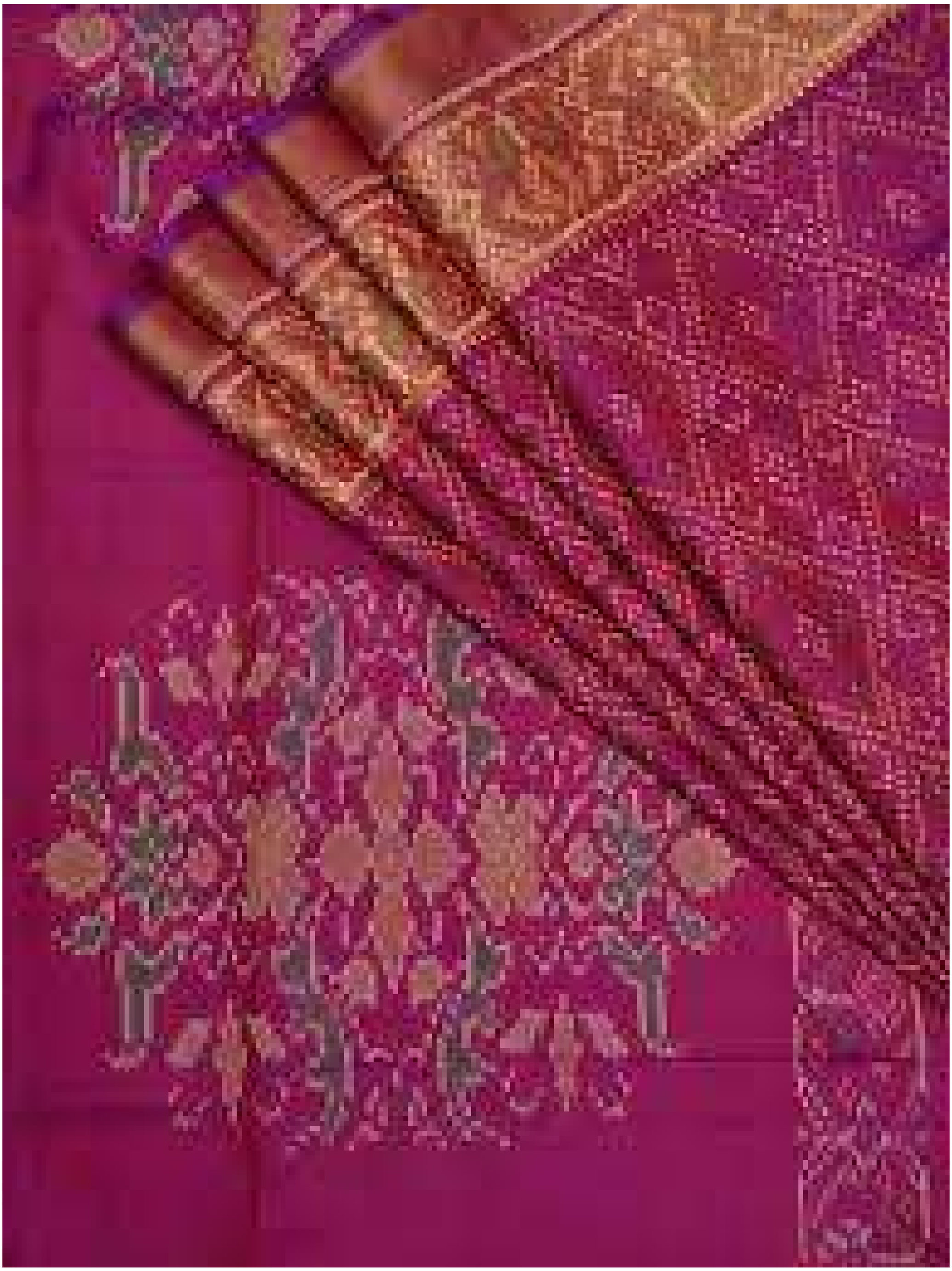


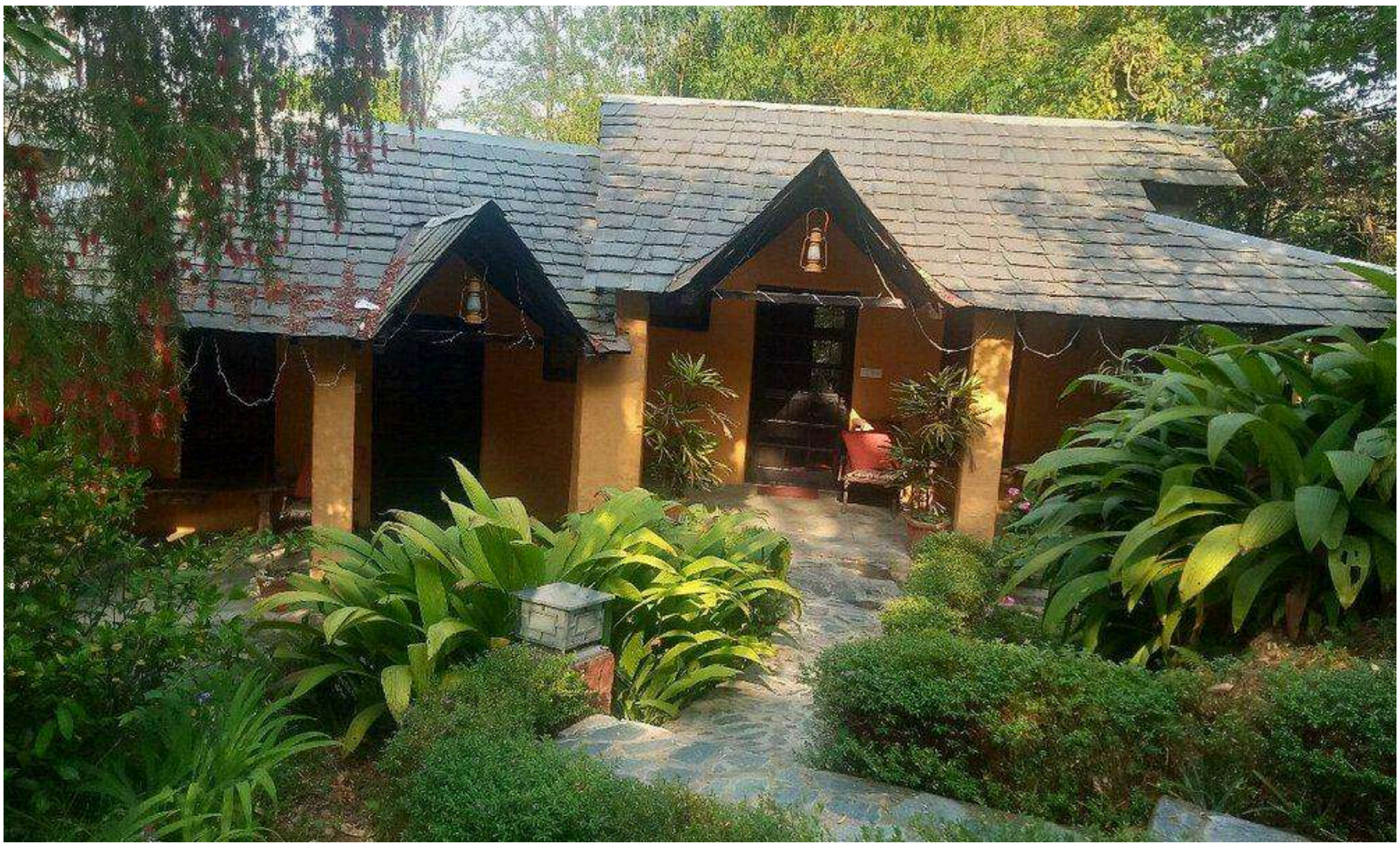
Raghurajpur, **Odisha**, the patachitra village an hour away from Bhubaneswar, has several national award-winning artists, living and working at the 900 year old art, all within two square kilometres of a picturesque land.




Incredible India
Rural Tourism Complex
Bhoodan Pochampally
Andhra Pradesh Tourism Development Corporation

Pochampally, Telangana, was named the Best World Tourism Village by the UNWTO in 2021. Home to more than 10,000 weaving families, it uses traditional ikat looms, patterns and techniques that have existed for centuries. Microsoft and Chaitanya Bharathi Institute of Technology have partnered to create special skill development programs and digital literacy initiatives for the community.





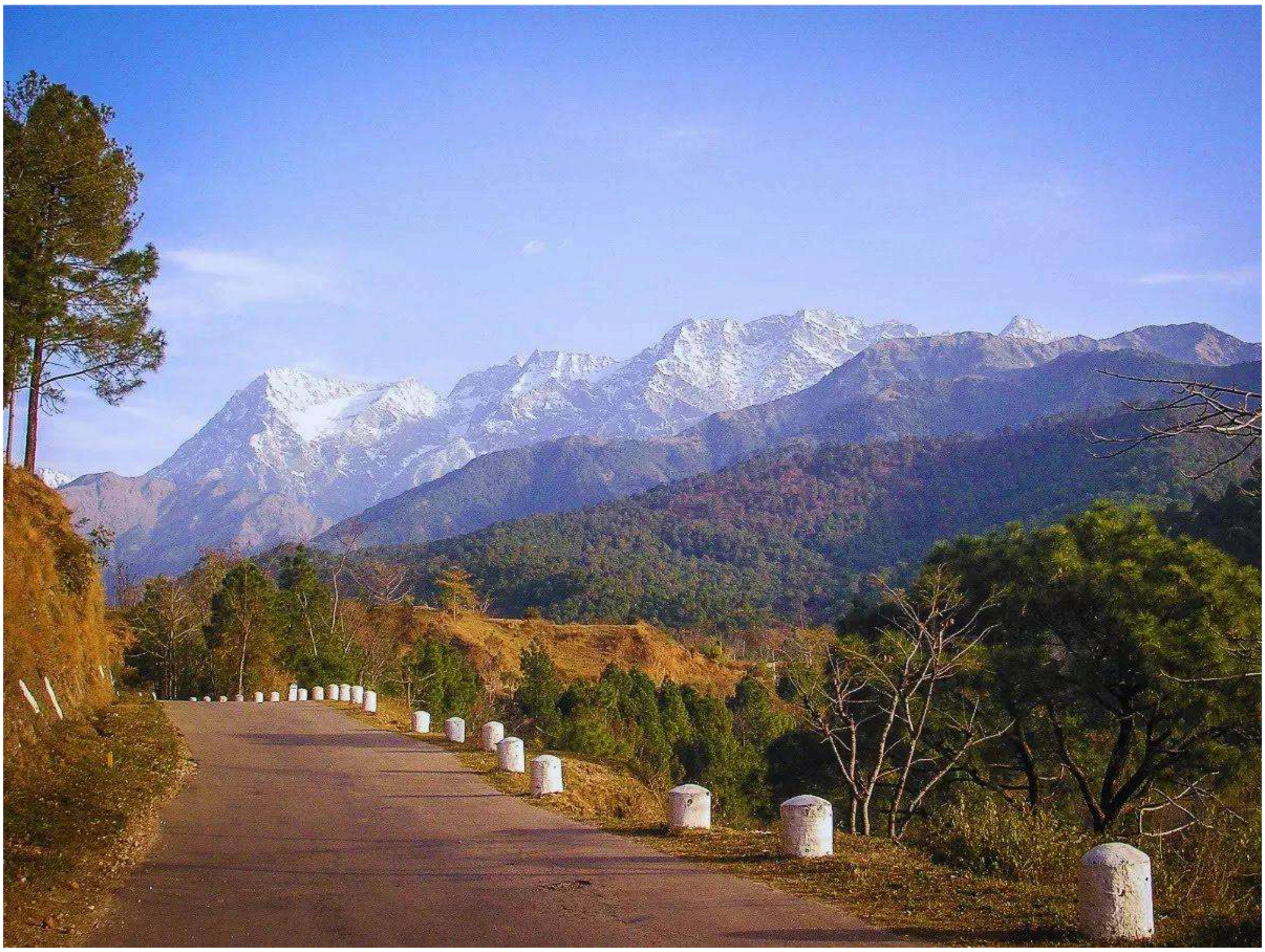
Andretta in the Kangra Valley is a century-old arts and culture village, now home to a vibrant and close-knit community of painters, potters, and artisans of Himachali craft.



At the Pottery and Crafts Society, one can see skilled potters at work moulding clay into beautiful objects of art; visitors are welcome to muddy their hands at the wheels.



That’s when they are not browsing the many art galleries and curio studios in the village, set amid the serene mountains.



The tea garden town of Palampur, a short drive away, has several charming homestays and is accessible by train, road and yes, even air.

The next time you plan a holiday somewhere in India, do choose one that includes a craft village resort nearby. **Rewarding for you, for the artisans and surely for the planet.**

